

SailPoint Identity Security Cloud (ISC)

RFP Fit Assessment Report

Client / Solicitation: Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (RPI)
RFP Number: RPI PS-RFP-2027-0262
RFP Title: AI Enabled Data Ecosystem
RFP Date: 07/06/2026 (Updated 9/16/2025)
Assessment Subject: SailPoint Identity Security Cloud (ISC)
Report Date: July 20, 2026

VERDICT: NOT A FIT AS A PRIMARY RESPONSE

SailPoint Identity Security Cloud (ISC) is **not a suitable primary product or bid vehicle** for this RFP. Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (RPI) is buying a **Microsoft-centric data/AI consulting engagement**, not an identity governance platform. ISC addresses a different problem space than the one this RFP defines.

There is a **narrow adjacent / future opportunity** around identity governance beyond Entra ID, but that is outside the scope and evaluation criteria of this solicitation.

1. Executive Summary

RPI is seeking a hands-on consulting partner to design and begin implementing a modern, secure, AI-enabled enterprise data ecosystem **grounded in the Microsoft platform**. The engagement supports the RPI Forward priority to become a data-informed organization, with initial focus on student lifecycle and stakeholder engagement use cases.

SailPoint ISC is a cloud-native Identity Governance and Administration (IGA) platform focused on access lifecycle management, certifications, provisioning, separation of duties, and AI-assisted identity risk insights. While identity and role-based access are themes within the RFP, RPI has already designated **Microsoft Entra ID** as its identity foundation and **Microsoft Purview, Fabric, and Copilot** as the data/AI stack.

Conclusion: ISC should not be positioned as the primary solution or primary bid response for this solicitation. It may be relevant later as a complementary IGA initiative outside this RFP’s scope.

2. What This RFP Is Actually Buying

Understanding the procurement category is essential. This is a services engagement for architecture, co-development, and enablement—not a product RFP for identity security software.

Dimension	RFP Asks For	SailPoint ISC Provides
Buyer type	Consulting partner working side-by-side with DotCIO	SaaS IGA product (+ partner ecosystem)
Core platform	Microsoft Secure Enterprise Foundation	SailPoint Atlas / Identity Security Cloud
Primary outcomes	Target data architecture, Fabric analytics, Purview governance, Copilot/agentic AI MVPs	Access lifecycle, certifications, provisioning, SoD, access requests

Dimension	RFP Asks For	SailPoint ISC Provides
12-month success	Data products, dashboards, AI insights, staff enablement on Microsoft stack	Identity security posture and access automation
Identity stance	Entra ID already chosen as identity foundation	Enterprise IGA that can complement Entra, but is not Entra

RPI's Secure Enterprise Foundation is explicitly defined as:

- **Microsoft Entra ID** — identity and access
- **Microsoft Purview** — data governance and compliance
- **Microsoft Fabric / Azure data services** — analytics
- **Microsoft 365 Copilot** — AI productivity

This architectural direction is a decision already made. The RFP is about designing and piloting a data ecosystem **on that stack**, not evaluating alternative identity platforms.

3. Why SailPoint ISC Is Not a Fit

3.1 Wrong Solicitation Type

The RFP seeks qualified consulting firms for discovery, architecture, co-development, and knowledge transfer—not a product license or IGA implementation. Evaluation criteria emphasize co-development, Microsoft platform depth, and higher-education delivery—not IGA feature completeness.

Category Mismatch

ISC = product. This RFP = Microsoft data/AI services partner.

3.2 Identity Is Already Decided (Entra ID)

Submission and evaluation questions require proposers to describe role-based AI experiences using Entra ID; demonstrate hands-on experience with Entra ID identity governance / RBAC; and articulate how identity, Purview, Fabric, and Copilot work together architecturally.

Proposing SailPoint as the identity layer would conflict with the stated architectural direction. Even SailPoint's Entra connector story is “integrate with Entra,” not “replace RPI's Secure Enterprise Foundation.”

3.3 Core Technical Scope Is Data + AI, Not IGA

In-scope work under the RFP includes:

- Current-state discovery of data, reporting, integrations, and governance
- Microsoft-aligned target architecture (ingestion, Fabric, Purview, Copilot)
- Student lifecycle and stakeholder engagement data products, metrics, and dashboards
- Data governance operating model (stewardship, FERPA / HIPAA / CUI)
- Staff enablement so DotCIO can independently extend the ecosystem
- Phased investment roadmap aligned to RPI Forward

SailPoint ISC does **not** deliver the following core RFP outcomes:

- Enterprise data warehouse / lakehouse design
- Microsoft Fabric semantic models
- Purview classification, lineage, and DLP for institutional data assets
- Copilot / Copilot Studio / agentic AI enablement
- Cross-domain analytics (prospect → student → alumni)
- Marketing / advancement data products

3.4 Evaluation Weighting Works Against SailPoint

RPI will evaluate proposals using a best-value approach. The weighting below shows where SailPoint ISC (as product) or SailPoint (as product vendor) would struggle:

Evaluation Criterion	Weight	Fit for ISC / SailPoint as Bidder
Microsoft platform depth (Entra, Purview, Fabric, Copilot)	25%	Weak — not SailPoint's core offering
Strategic alignment to Microsoft AI data ecosystem	20%	Weak — wrong architectural narrative
Co-development & knowledge transfer	20%	Only if bidding as a Microsoft consulting SI, not as ISC
Student lifecycle / engagement data products	15%	Weak — analytics domain, not access governance
Higher education / regulated environment experience	10%	Moderate — SailPoint has HE customers, but for IGA
Cost, value, and proposed team	10%	N/A as product vs. services mismatch

Roughly 60%+ of scoring is Microsoft data/AI architecture and delivery model—not IGA.

3.5 Business Cases Are Analytics, Not Identity Lifecycle

The two initial domains are (1) **Student Lifecycle** — prospect → applicant → enrolled student → graduate → alumni, focused on insight, advising, and reporting; and (2) **Stakeholder Engagement & Marketing** — students, alumni, donors, legislators, and community partners.

These are cross-domain data views and AI-assisted insights, not joiner/mover/leaver provisioning use cases. Ellucian Banner and Advance are systems of record for the *data ecosystem*, not primarily SailPoint connector targets in this statement of work.

4. Where SailPoint Does Overlap (Limited / Adjacent)

The following themes appear in the RFP and align with SailPoint strengths, but they are **secondary** to what RPI is asking for—and are assigned to Microsoft technologies:

RPI Need (from RFP language)	SailPoint ISC Relevance	Why It Is Not Enough
"Respect identity and role-based permissions" for AI	Strong IGA / RBAC / access governance	RPI specifies Entra ID for this capability
Role-based self-service data access	Access request / role models	They want Entra + Purview + Fabric security models

RPI Need (from RFP language)	SailPoint ISC Relevance	Why It Is Not Enough
Auditability of access	Certifications and access history	Purview audit + Entra logs are the named stack
Secure by design / least privilege	Core SailPoint value proposition	Already anchored in Microsoft Secure Enterprise Foundation
Future Ellucian Banner / HR access automation	Common SailPoint higher-ed use case	Not in this SOW; would be a separate initiative

Bottom Line on Overlap

ISC could strengthen RPI's identity security program later; it does not satisfy this RFP's deliverables or evaluation model.

5. Part-by-Part RFP Mapping

The following table maps major RFP sections and goals to SailPoint ISC fit:

RFP Section / Goal	Fit?	Notes
I–III Design AI-enabled data ecosystem on Microsoft	No	Wrong platform and engagement type
Secure Enterprise Foundation (Entra, Purview, Fabric, Copilot)	No	Explicitly Microsoft; ISC is not a substitute
Student lifecycle data products	No	Analytics / Fabric domain
Stakeholder engagement / marketing insights	No	CRM / advancement analytics
Responsible agentic AI / Copilot	No	Microsoft Copilot Studio + Purview + Entra
Data governance operating model	Partial / Weak	SailPoint governs access; Purview governs data
Integration appliance / hybrid integration	No	iPaaS / integration platform — not ISC
FERPA / HIPAA / CUI protection	Partial	ISC helps control who gets access; RFP wants classification, lineage, AI controls via Purview
Co-development & DotCIO enablement	Only as consulting SI	SailPoint product alone does not answer this
Section VI Q1–5 Microsoft architecture / Purview / Entra AI roles	No	Directly Microsoft-centric questionnaire
Section VI Q9–10 HE student/alumni data challenges	Weak	HE data modeling ≠ HE IGA
Tech specs (Jaggaer, WCAG, US residency, SSO)	Incidental	Apply to any awarded supplier; not a fit driver
Evaluation B (25%) Entra / Purview / Fabric / Copilot	No	Decisive mismatch with SailPoint core

6. Recommended Posture (If Representing SailPoint or a Partner)

6.1 Do Not Bid This as an ISC Product Play

Responding as “SailPoint ISC for identity” would miss the stated need and score poorly on the largest evaluation buckets (Microsoft platform depth and strategic alignment).

6.2 Only Consider Bidding If...

You are (or partner with) a Microsoft Fabric / Purview / Copilot consulting practice that can lead the engagement, and SailPoint is at most a future-state IGA option—not the core proposal. Even then, lead with Microsoft services credentials, not ISC.

6.3 Better Adjacent Plays (Outside This RFP)

- **Separate IGA conversation** after or beside this project: Banner, Advance, HR, research systems, privileged / non-employee access, certifications, and SoD.
- **Position vs. Entra ID Governance:** where RPI may outgrow native Entra for complex higher-ed role models, orphaned access, or multi-ERP provisioning.
- **AI access governance as a follow-on:** who can use which Copilot agents / data products—complementary to Purview, not a replacement for Fabric work.

7. Summary Findings

Question	Answer
Is SailPoint ISC a fit for this project?	No — not as primary solution or primary bid.
Why?	RFP is for Microsoft data/AI ecosystem consulting; ISC is enterprise IGA SaaS.
Any parts that fit?	Only adjacent identity / RBAC / audit themes — and those are assigned to Entra ID + Purview.
Risk of forcing a fit?	High: architectural conflict with Microsoft Secure Enterprise Foundation, weak evaluation scores, wrong supplier category.
Future opportunity?	Yes — standalone IGA / lifecycle / certification program for Ellucian and enterprise apps, after or parallel to this data ecosystem work.

One-Line Takeaway

This RFP is a Microsoft Fabric + Purview + Copilot + Entra **consulting** engagement for an AI-ready data ecosystem; SailPoint ISC is an **IGA product** and does not meet what RPI is asking for here.

Appendix A — RFP Reference Facts

Item	Detail
Issuing organization	Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY

Item	Detail
RFP contacts	Tim D'Allaird (Procurement); Andrea Ballinger (CIO)
Core systems of record (current)	Ellucian Banner; Ellucian Advance
Initial domain focus	Student Lifecycle; Stakeholder Engagement & Marketing
Engagement horizon	Measurable progress within 12 months; project at least 18 months
Proposal due	08/17/2026 (via Jaggaer Sourcing Director)
Estimated project start	November 2026
Source document	Rensselaer_Polytechnic_Institute_RFP_e359.pdf

Appendix B — Document Control

Document title: SailPoint ISC Fit Assessment — RPI AI Enabled Data Ecosystem RFP

Classification: Confidential — Internal / Opportunity Assessment

Purpose: Determine whether SailPoint Identity Security Cloud is an appropriate response vehicle or solution for RPI PS-RFP-2027-0262

Methodology: Full review of the 18-page RFP against SailPoint ISC product capabilities (IGA, lifecycle, certifications, provisioning, Entra integration model) and RPI's stated Microsoft Secure Enterprise Foundation